Canva Cheat Sheet

Baseline checked 2026-11-07 · Canva AI 2.0: research preview since 2026-04-16, no published GA date · no prices: see canva.com/pricing

1 Products and plans

Visual Suite: Design, Presentations, Docs, Whiteboards, Video, Websites, Sheets, Code, Forms, Email, Social planner, Grow; Affinity (free app); Canva AI assistant.
Plans: Free, Pro, Business (replaced Teams for new sign-ups), Enterprise; Education and Nonprofits free premium. Add-on: AI Pass.
AI tiers: Standard (unmetered on paid plans) · Premium (allowance: Magic Layers, Code, generate design) · Ultra (most allowance: conversational design, video clips).

2 Editor

Side panel tabs: Design, Elements, Text, Brand, Uploads, Tools, Projects, Apps, Canva AI. **Quick actions:** `/` or `Cmd/Ctrl+E`. Page views: single page, thumbnails, scroll, grid.

Action	macOS	Windows
Undo / Redo	Cmd+Z / Cmd+Y	Ctrl+Z / Ctrl+Y
Duplicate	Cmd+D	Ctrl+D
Group / ungroup	Cmd+G / +Shift	Ctrl+G / +Shift
Side panel	Cmd+/	Ctrl+/
Add link	Cmd+K	Ctrl+K
New page	Cmd+Return	Ctrl+Enter
Layers	Option+1	Alt+1

Tools: `T` text, `R` rectangle, `L` line, `C` circle, `S` sticky.

3 Design principles

- **Contrast:** text 4.5:1, large text 3:1
- **Balance:** distribute visual weight
- **Alignment:** shared edges or centre lines
- **Proximity:** group related items
- **Repetition:** reuse styles
- **Hierarchy:** size, weight, colour
- **Colour harmony:** 60-30-10 mix
- **Type pairing:** 2 fonts, contrasting roles



4 Building blocks

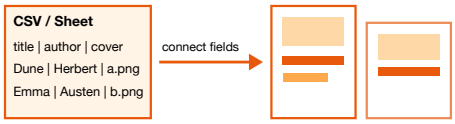
- **Templates** and Magic Design; Text effects (shadow, glow, curve, hollow)
- **Elements:** shapes, lines, graphics, charts, tables
- **Frames/grids** crop photos; rulers and guides align
- **Layers:** arrange forward/back, lock, group; Position tab aligns
- **Colour:** document colours, gradients, palettes, eyedropper
- **Photo edits:** crop, adjust, filters, shadows, background remover
- **AI photo tools:** Magic Eraser, Edit, Expand, Grab Text, Upscaler

5 Visual Suite products

- **Presentations:** modes (Present, Presenter view, Auto-play, Present and record), Canva Live Q&A
- **Docs** with blocks, **Whiteboards** with sticky notes
- **Video:** timeline, multi-track, Beat Sync, auto captions, voiceover
- **Websites:** publish, free or custom domain, Magic SEO
- **Sheets:** Magic Formulas, Magic Insights
- **Code** (prompt to widget), **Forms**, **Email**

6 Scale

Magic Resize: up to 5 new sizes per design, 50 designs and 250 outputs per bulk action. **Bulk Create:** up to 300 rows x 150 columns, one media item per cell. **Translate** designs. **Content Planner:** schedule social posts. **Canva Grow:** ads and analytics.



7 Canva AI

- **Assistant:** prompt to design, edit, write, research
- **Magic tools:** Magic Write, Media, Edit, Expand, Eraser, Grab Text, Layers, Animate
- **Image and video:** Dream Lab, Craft image model, clip generation
- **Rules of thumb:** check the licence of generated and stock media, review output, keep records of prompts, never paste confidential data
- Usage draws on the monthly AI allowance

8 Brand

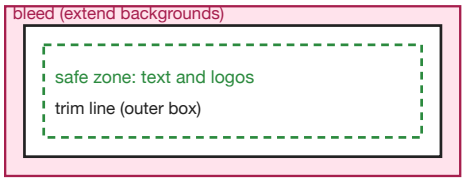
- **Brand kit:** logos, colours, fonts, photos, graphics
- **Brand voice:** tone for Magic Write
- **Brand templates:** lock elements, set fields
- **Controls:** restrict uploads, fonts and colours
- **Approvals:** request review before publish

9 Collaboration

Permission levels: view, comment, edit. **Comments** and @mentions; **version history** restores earlier states. **Roles:** owner, admin, brand designer, member (team); organization admin and brand designer; groups. Education roles for classes.

10 Output and accessibility

Format chooser: PNG (images), JPG (photos, small), PDF Standard (share), PDF Print (CMYK, bleed, crop marks), MP4 (video), GIF (loop), SVG (vector, paid), PPTX.



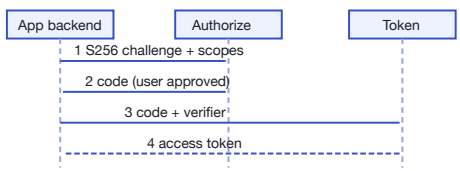
A11y checklist: File > Accessibility > check design; text 12 pt or more; contrast; alt text, decorative flag; reading order; captions; reduce motion.

11 Developers

`npm i -g @canva/cli`, `canva login`, `canva apps create`, `canva apps start`, `canva api` (REST).

```
await openDesign({type:"current_page"},
async s => { /* edit */ await s.sync();
})
```

PKCE: verifier → S256 challenge → authorize URL (scopes, state) → user approves → code → backend POST `/oauth/token` with verifier.



Export job: `POST /v1/exports` then poll `GET /v1/exports/{id}`. **Autofill:** `POST /v1/autofills`, poll. **MCP:** `claude mcp add --transport http canva https://api.canva.com/connect/v1/mcp` with CANVA_CLIENT_ID from the environment.

Changed since older tutorials: Teams → Business · glow-up editor and Tools tab · Magic Switch → Magic Resize · Canva AI 2.0 (research preview) · Canva Craft · multi-track video · new products: Sheets, Code, Forms, Email, Grow · Affinity now one free app · Connect APIs → REST APIs · Canva Button retired.